Plan a circle: “Brave New World”

Aldous Huxley (1932) · novel · grades 11–12 (English III–IV) · ~3 weeks. Rights: Copyrighted.

Kit section 5 (group agreement & calendar) filled in for one text — a finished plan students see before writing their own. ***Tinted italic*** = sample answers.

Preview note: Copyrighted, mature — use a previewed edition. Contains drug use, sexual content, and mature themes; plan context and support. Verify all plot details against the book.

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Text, group, and target

Text / author / edition	***“Brave New World” — Aldous Huxley (1932). Novel.***
Group / period / dates	***Bea’s group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___***
Grade / TEKS target (p. 3)	English IV · §110.39 — 6(A): relationships among literary elements; 5(C,D): evaluative commentary and summary; 1(D): student-led discussion.
Learning intention	We are learning to explain how the World State’s design reveals a theme about freedom, technology, and stability.
Success criteria	I bring one open question, cite two details by chapter (paraphrased), respond to a peer, and name how my thinking changed.

Reading map & calendar

Chunk	Read through	Meeting date · leader
1	***Ch. 1–6: the World State, conditioning, castes, soma; Bernard and Lenina.***	***Wk 1 · Leader: Bea***
2	***Ch. 7–13: the Reservation, and John the Savage brought to London.***	***Wk 2 · Leader: Juan***
3	***Ch. 14–18: John’s rebellion, the debate with Mond, and the tragic end.***	***Wk 3 · Leader: Val***

Members & first-meeting jobs (p. 7 roles)

Member	First job	Rotates to (next meeting)
Bea	***Questioner***	***Summarizer***
Juan	***Summarizer***	***Clarifier***
Val	***Clarifier***	***Evidence tracker***
Rai	***Predictor***	***Questioner***

Text-specific discussion questions (open — more than one answer)

- **Predict:** A society engineered for happiness and stability — what will it have to give up to keep them?
- **Question:** Why might Huxley make the “Savage” the one who defends suffering and freedom?
- **Clarify:** What does Mustapha Mond mean that they sacrificed truth and beauty for comfort?
- **Summarize:** Trace how John’s view of the “brave new world” changes, without opinion.
- **Interpret the theme:** How does the World State’s design reveal a theme about freedom vs. stability? Use two details (paraphrase).

Optional Jigsaw lenses (p. 4): ***Character*** (John, Bernard, and Mond) · ***Setting*** (the World State) · ***Theme*** (freedom vs. stability) · ***Structure*** (London vs. the Reservation) · ***Symbol*** (soma).

Sample 3–2–1 notes: Val, theme lens

Name: Val · Home group: Bea's group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___ · Section: "Brave New World," Chunk 3 · Expert lens: Theme

What a finished prep looks like. Kit section 6 / Organizer A completed for one reader, so students can compare their notes to a strong model. Paraphrase and short references only — no long copying. Paraphrase only — no quotations; verify details against the book.

Questions

Is stability worth losing freedom?

Why does John demand the "right to be unhappy"?

3 · Important ideas

1. Citizens are engineered into castes and kept content with soma.

2. John, raised outside, values freedom, art, and even pain.

3. Mond explains that stability requires giving up truth and high art.

Vocabulary

conditioning = engineered training of behavior.

soma = the state-issued pleasure drug.

2 · Supporting details

1. Soma erases any discontent (throughout). → Comfort replaces freedom. (Verify against the text.)

2. John demands the "right to be unhappy" in the debate (Ch. 17). → The human cost of engineered happiness. (Verify against the text.)

1 · Summary in my own words

A stable, engineered society trades freedom, truth, and art for comfort; an outsider's refusal exposes that bargain.

Bring to the circle

My interpretation: ***A life engineered for comfort may cost the very freedom that makes it meaningful.***
Synthesis (two lenses): ***John (character) voices the theme: his defense of suffering reveals what the World State sacrificed for stability. Text points (paraphrased): soma's use and the Mond debate (Chunk 3).***
After discussion: ***My thinking became clearer once the group compared evidence.***

TEKS evidence: 6(C,D) supported inference; 7(A) theme through characters/events; 1(D) response to a peer. · Pair with the PlotPoint "Brave New World" room.